Alex Rekas

Design Lead & Product Designer

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Summary

Design Lead with 12+ years making complex, regulated platforms clear and trustworthy across healthcare, government, and enterprise SaaS. I turn dense policy and operational logic into decision-support workflows, partnering with product, engineering, and compliance from problem framing through delivery. I build with AI every day: I direct AI agents to take work from Figma into production-ready components, and I prototype in Claude and Figma Make. Led a multi-state healthcare platform to WCAG 2.1 AA / Section 508 compliance.

Work Experience

IdeaCrew / Design Lead

7/2020 - PRESENT, DC & REMOTE

- Lead design for a multi-state health-insurance marketplace (DC, Maine, Massachusetts), defining shared workflows and patterns for eligibility, income verification, and subsidy determinations.
- Translate complex healthcare policy and operational logic into clear decision-support workflows that reduce administrative burden for applicants and state staff.
- Present designs directly to state clients and turn their feedback and policy requirements into prioritized product decisions.
- Rethought legacy workflows as design lead on a $1M+ platform modernization (Bootstrap 3 to 4/5), improving UX across dozens of screens and bringing the full design system into WCAG 2.1 AA / 508 compliance.
- Built the design system behind the Enroll platform by directing an AI coding agent: one token set themes three state brands in light and dark mode, flowing from Figma to Storybook to Rails components, with automated WCAG 2.1 AA and visual-regression checks in CI.
- Prototype and validate new product concepts rapidly with AI-native tools (Claude, Figma Make), using AI for research synthesis and ideation, then lead design reviews to align cross-functional teams.
- Led the 2026 IdeaCrew rebrand from concept through launch.
- Designed WorkRadar, a greenfield COVID return-to-work app, end to end through build-ready design.

Contract & Freelance / Product & UX Designer

4/2016 - PRESENT, DC & REMOTE

Centers for Disease Control & Prevention (CDC)

- Built wireframes for cdc.gov aligned with newly established federal design guidelines.
- Conducted a heuristic evaluation of cdc.gov, producing a prioritized report of usability findings and recommendations.
- Developed storyboards for digital content deployed across the website and social channels.

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- Conducted user interviews with current and prospective users to inform product decisions and surface unmet needs.
- Communicated design rationale and UX objectives to stakeholders through wireframes and structured presentations.

Marriott International

- Led product and UX design for employee training systems, improving usability and the learner experience.
- Provided creative direction for brand photography, visual systems, and print media for internal communications.
- Designed logo identities and visual systems for internal teams and events within Marriott's enterprise brand standards.

Work Experience (Continued)

Distributed Solutions / Designer
4/2013 - 4/2016, RESTON VA

- Designed wireframes and high-fidelity mockups for new features and iterative updates across a multi-product enterprise software suite.
- Partnered closely with engineering to implement designs, maintaining visual guidelines and a shared asset library across the product portfolio.

Skills

Design: Product strategy, end-to-end product design, complex workflow and decision-support design, interaction design, information architecture, user research, usability testing, accessibility (WCAG 2.1 AA / Section 508), service design, design systems, brand identity
AI-assisted building: Directing AI coding agents (Claude) from Figma to production components; rapid prototyping in Claude and Figma Make; AI-assisted research synthesis
Tools: Figma, Figma Make, Claude, Storybook (via AI-agent workflows), Adobe Creative Suite
Domain: Healthcare technology, government / federal, enterprise B2B SaaS

Education

James Madison University
B.S. Studio Art - Industrial Design
2010, HARRISONBURG VA

Northern VA Community College
A.S. Mathematics
2008, LOUDOUN VA

*Summer design studio in Vienna, Austria and volunteer work for the specialized architecture program, Rural Studio at Auburn University in Alabama.